

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-II

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. There are TWENTY questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. Questions 1-10 carry 10 marks each and should be answered in 150 words.
3. Questions 11-20 carry 15 marks each and should be answered in 250 words.
4. Answers must remain relevant to the demand and use appropriate examples.

Q1. Collective responsibility is both a rule of government survival and a rule of cabinet solidarity. Analyse with judicial support.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q2. Examine the claim that e-governance projects carry a built-in bias towards technology and back-end integration rather than user-centric designs.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q3. Suggest measures to remedy the inadequate attention given to human-resource development in India.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q4. Distinguish federalism from administrative decentralisation and explain why India remains federal despite a strong Union.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q5. Distinguish digital public infrastructure from e-governance with Indian examples and explain why the distinction changes the governance question.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q6. Distinguish the three categories of right recognised by the Forest Rights Act, 2006, and explain what each secures.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q7. Distinguish the Inter-State Council, Zonal Councils, North Eastern Council and NITI Aayog by source, composition logic and function.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q8. Discuss the claim that democratic governance requires the public perception of the integrity and commitment of civil servants to be positive.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q9. Distinguish the constitutional recognition in NALSA v. Union of India from the statutory scheme of the 2019 Act, and explain why the distinction matters in an answer.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q10. An external attack affecting only one State does not mechanically trigger President's Rule. Explain the correct constitutional analysis.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Q11. Critically examine the representative and sovereign character of the Constituent Assembly.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q12. Examine the claim that public charitable trusts have the potential to make India's development more inclusive because they relate to vital public issues.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q13. Examine the universalism-versus-targeting choice in India's welfare design, including the errors that each design generates.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q14. Examine India's simultaneous engagement with the United States, China and Russia during 2024 to 2026 as a test of hedging capacity.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q15. "India is federal in structure but possesses a pronounced centralising capacity." Discuss.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q16. Examine micro-finance as an anti-poverty instrument and the role of self-help groups in achieving asset creation and income security.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q17. Assess whether India's food-security architecture has converted a discretionary scheme into an enforceable entitlement.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q18. Examine the instruments through which India converts the SAGAR doctrine into island-state partnership, and state what those instruments do not establish.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q19. Article 368 reaches the Preamble, but the basic features declared in the Preamble do not yield to Article 368. Critically examine.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Q20. Examine the claim that a social audit produces answerability but not necessarily enforceability.

[15 marks | 250 words]

END OF PAPER